UX Research Proposal

Project: Acminder Scheduling Application

Prepared for: UX Research Course

Date: February 15, 2026

Research Objectives (SMART Goals)

- Identify at least 3 recurring patterns in how students consolidate deadlines from multiple sources based on thematic analysis of 5 interviews.
- Categorize at least 5 distinct emotional or cognitive barriers to acting on schedule alerts, validated by at least 2 participants each.
- Measure trust in AI scheduling suggestions and determine if at least 60% of participants rate trust at 4 or higher on a 5-point scale.
- Ensure at least 80% of participants complete onboarding and articulate the value proposition within 3 minutes.
- Confirm that 75% of users interpret reminder formats correctly within 10 seconds.
- Validate that 70% of participants resolve a scheduling conflict within 60 seconds without moderator assistance.

Recruitment Plan

- Primary Users: Working Students (18–25) and Lifelong Learners (26–45).
- Inclusion Criteria: Enrolled in a course, at least one recurring commitment, uses digital calendar.
- Exclusion Criteria: No recurring commitments or exclusively paper planners.
- Participants: 5 for discovery, 5–8 for usability testing.
- Recruitment Channels: Campus boards, online communities, personal networks.

Research Methods

- Contextual Interviews (30 minutes) to understand scheduling workflows and barriers.
- Moderated Usability Testing using high-fidelity prototype.
- Tasks: Onboarding & schedule import, add work shift, resolve scheduling conflict.
- Metrics: Task success rate, time on task, error rate, satisfaction rating (1–5).

Ethical Considerations

- Participants will sign informed consent forms.
- Participation is voluntary and can be withdrawn at any time.
- Sessions may be audio-recorded and deleted at semester end.
- Participants will be anonymized in reports.
- AI features are optional and clearly labeled.

Timeline

- Week 4–5: Finalize research plan and recruit participants.
- Week 6: Conduct discovery interviews.
- Week 7: Conduct usability testing.
- Week 8: Data consolidation and analysis.
- Week 9–10: Draft and finalize research report.